

PREPRINTS AND MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

§ Mentees in the lab. ± Co-mentored students. † Shared senior authors.

1. **Lin, C.**, & Thornton, M. (2026). Bottom-up and top-down information determinants of naturalistic trait impression updating. *PsyArXiv*.
[\[Preprint\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Preregistration\]](#)
2. Lu, J. §, & **Lin, C.** (2026). Stereotypes as byproducts of hierarchical Bayesian inference. *PsyArXiv*.
[\[Preprint\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Preregistration\]](#)
3. Zheng, R. §, Liu, K. §, Zou, J. §, & **Lin, C.** (2026). Facial and body actions speak louder than context when inferring facial expressions of emotions in naturalistic images. *PsyArXiv*.
[\[Preprint\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Preregistration\]](#)
4. Mao, Y. § & **Lin, C.** (2026). Inferring corruptible politicians from faces applies only if they are White. *PsyArXiv*.
[\[Preprint\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Preregistration\]](#)
5. Lu, J. § & **Lin, C.** (2025). Small-World Minds Create the Illusion of Low-Dimensional Social Cognition Under Constrained Stimuli. *PsyArXiv*.
[\[Preprint\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#)
6. Zheng, R. § & **Lin, C.** (2024). Not what you were born with: people prioritize controllable cues when forming first impressions in naturalistic contexts. *PsyArXiv*.
[\[Preprint\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Preregistration\]](#)
7. Wang, Y. § & **Lin, C.** (2024). Beyond trait summaries: stereotypes as multimodal mental representations of groups across perceivers, situations, and intersecting categories. *PsyArXiv*.
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PUBLICATIONS

§ Mentees in the lab. ± Co-mentored students. † Shared senior authors.

8. Xu, Y. ±, Keles, U., **Lin, C.** †, & Adolphs, R. †. (conditional acceptance). Trait judgments of faces using a task without word labels. *Nature Human Behaviour*.
[\[Preprint\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Preregistration\]](#)
9. **Lin, C.**, & Thornton, M. (conditional acceptance). Fooled by beautiful data: Visualization aesthetics bias trust in science, news, and social media. *Psychological Science*.

[\[Preprint\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Preregistration\]](#) [\[Poster\]](#)

10. **Lin, C.**, Han, Y., Keles, U. Xu, Y, Lu, J., Zheng, R., & Adolphs, R. (2025). Investigating the structure of emotion: tools, pitfalls and recommendations. *Affective Science*.
[\[PDF\]](#)
11. Lu, J. § & **Lin, C.** (2025). Network models reveal high-dimensional social inferences in naturalistic settings beyond latent construct models. *Communications Psychology*.
[\[PDF\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Preregistration\]](#)
12. Freeman, J. B. & **Lin, C.** (2025). A high-dimensional model of social impressions. *Trends in Cognitive Sciences*.
[\[PDF\]](#)
13. Cao, R., Wang, J., **Lin, C.**, Rutishauser, U., Todorov, A., Li, X., Brandmeir, N., & Wang, S. (2025). Feature-based encoding of face identity by single neurons in the human medial temporal lobe. *Nature Human Behaviour*.
[\[PDF\]](#)
14. Xie, S. Y., Zheng, R. §, Hehman, E., & **Lin, C.** (2025). A tutorial on representational similarity analysis for research in social cognition. *Social Cognition*.
[\[PDF\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#)
15. **Lin, C.**, Keles, U., Thornton, M. A., & Adolphs, R. (2024). Trait impressions from faces shape mental state inferences. *Nature Human Behaviour*.
[\[PDF\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Stage 1 Protocol\]](#) [\[Stage 2 Full Manuscript\]](#)
16. Zhao, S., Cao, R., **Lin, C.** †, Shuo, W. †, & Yu, H. † (2024). Atypical link between social trait judgment and socio-emotional experience in autism spectrum disorder. *Scientific Reports*.
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17. Yu, H., **Lin, C.**, Sun, S., Cao, R., Kar, K., & Wang, S. (2023). Multimodal investigations of emotional face processing and social trait judgement of faces. *Annals of the New York Academy of Sciences*.
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18. **Lin, C.**, Bulls, L. S., Tepfer, L. J., Vyas, A. D., & Thornton, M. A. (2023). Advancing naturalistic affective science with deep learning. *Affective Science*, 4, 550–562.
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19. Cao, R., Zhang, N., Yu, H., Webster, P. J., Paul, L. K., Li, X., **Lin, C.** †, & Wang, S. † (2023) Comprehensive social trait judgments from faces in autism spectrum disorder. *Psychological Science*.
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20. **Lin, C., & Thornton, M.** (2023). Evidence for bidirectional causation between trait and mental state inferences. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*.
[\[PDF\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Preregistration\]](#) [\[Video\]](#)
21. **Lin, C., & Adolphs, R.** (2022). Trait impressions from faces depend on the goals of the perceiver: Commentary on Sutherland and Young. *British Journal of Psychology*.
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22. Cao, R., **Lin, C.**, Li, X., Todorov, A., Brandmeir, N., & Wang, S. (2022). A neuronal social trait space for first impressions in the human amygdala and hippocampus. *Molecular Psychiatry*.
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23. Cao, R., **Lin, C.**, Brandmeir, N., & Wang, S. (2022). A human single-neuron dataset for face perception. *Scientific Data*.
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24. Yu, H., Cao, R., **Lin, C.**, & Wang, S. (2022). Distinct neurocognitive bases for social trait judgments of faces in autism spectrum disorder. *Translational Psychiatry*.
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25. **Lin, C.**, Keles, U., & Adolphs, R. (2021). Four dimensions characterize attributions from faces using a representative set of English trait words. *Nature Communications*, 12 (1), 1-15.
[\[PDF\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#) [\[Preregistration\]](#) [\[Video\]](#)
26. Keles, U., **Lin, C.**, & Adolphs, R. (2021). A cautionary note on predicting social judgments from faces with deep neural networks. *Affective Science*, 2, 438-454.
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27. **Lin, C.**, Keles, U., Tyszka, J. M., Gallo, M., Paul, L., & Adolphs, R. (2020). No strong evidence that social network index is associated with gray matter volume from a data-driven investigation. *Cortex*, 125, 307-317.
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28. **Lin, C.**, & Alvarez, R. M. (2020). Personality traits are directly associated with anti-Black prejudice in the United States. *PLoS ONE*. 15(7), e0235436.
[\[PDF\]](#) [\[Data & Code\]](#)
29. **Lin, C.**, Adolphs, R., & Alvarez, R. M. (2018). Inferring whether officials are corruptible from looking at their faces. *Psychological Science*, 0956797618788882.
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30. **Lin, C.**, Adolphs, R., & Alvarez, R. M. (2017). Cultural effects on the association between election outcomes and face-based trait inferences. *PLoS ONE*, 12(7), e0180837.
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